

GUIDE of the Hermitage

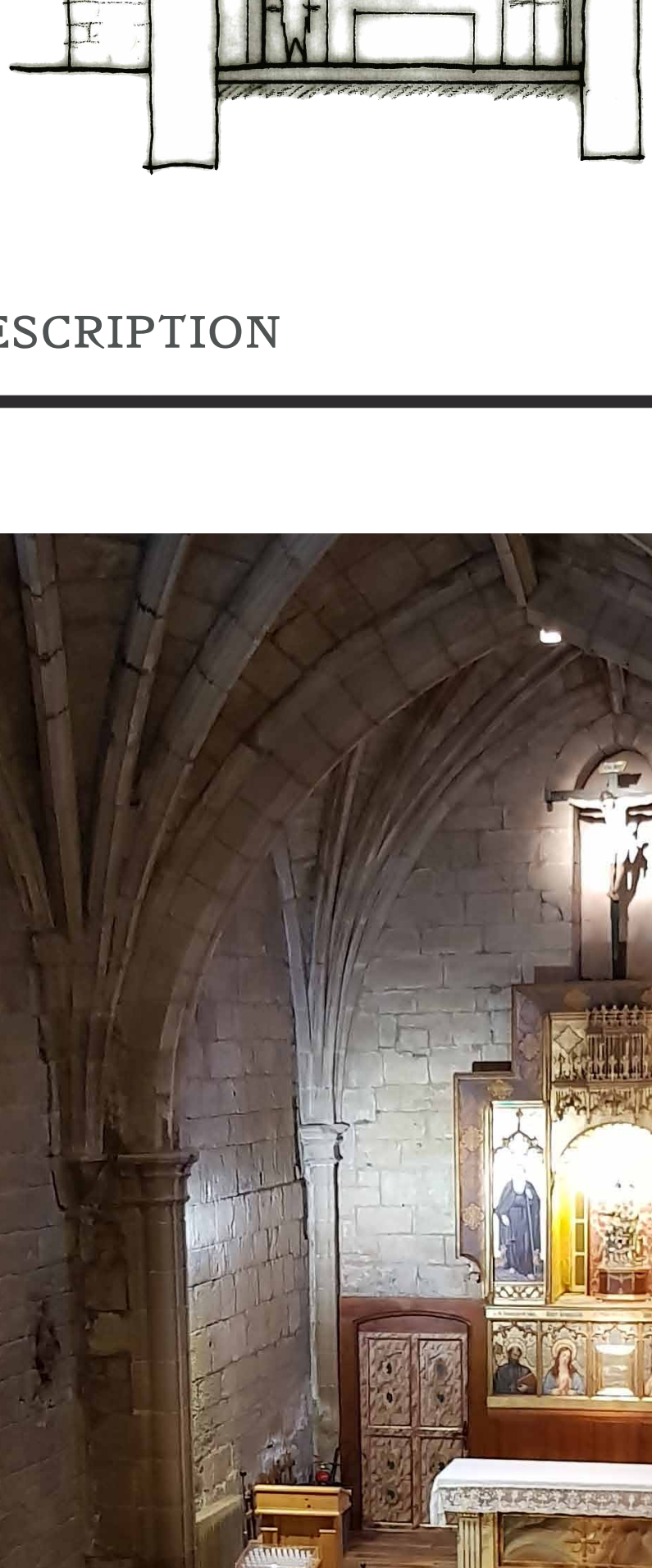
HISTORY

This chapel is located right in front of the facade of the Cathedral. This building has been built in rectangular plant ashlar. The door opens to the north and above it a niche holds an image of the seated Virgin, a Romanist from the end of the 16th century.

His feast is on September 18, together with the festivities of thanks for the collection of agricultural products. The building was built in the 16th century, with cover of the 18th century, on some previous constructions that have their origin in the Temple that Santo Domingo de la Calzada built and that, according to tradition, was dedicated to the Virgin Mary. Therefore, it is the oldest place of worship in the City.

The invocation of the image with the title of the Square, corresponds to the urban place it occupies and that is the small square that articulated the lives of the inhabitants, around the Pilgrim Hospital, today Parador de Turismo, the tomb of the Holy Founder and the street that crosses it, which is the Camino a Santiago itself.

PLAN OF THE HERMITAGE



DESCRIPTION



Hermitage of the Square

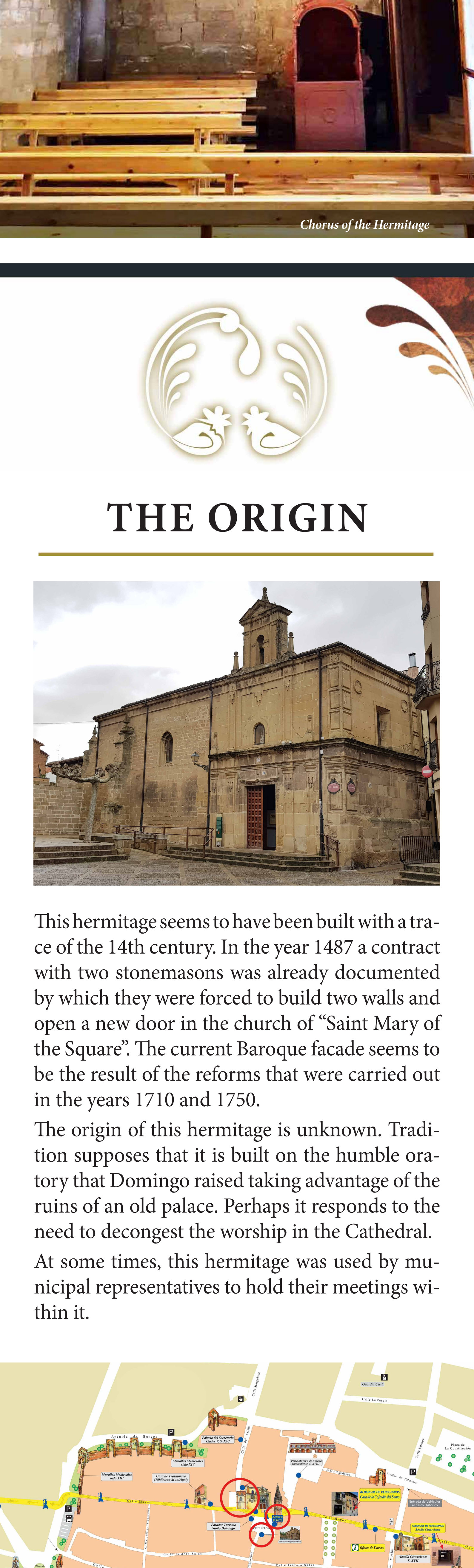
1.- The Virgin of the Square

The image of the Virgin of the Square that we contemplate inside is from the late Romanesque and presents us with the Virgin Mary who with her body and posture serves as a throne to offer us her Son Jesus.

On the outer door of the Hermitage, a niche houses the image of the White Virgin, a dedication that is celebrated on August 5 and closely linked to pilgrims, as it is celebrated in Rome, another great pilgrimage center.

At the end of this procession, and before the image is returned to her hermitage, he receives the greeting of her countrymen, in the form of the curious "somersaults".

Here was located a brotherhood that had several names: brotherhood of Our Lady of the Antique, or of the Snows, or of the Square, as it appears in the documentation of the 16th century. Its main festival was celebrated in the first days of August.

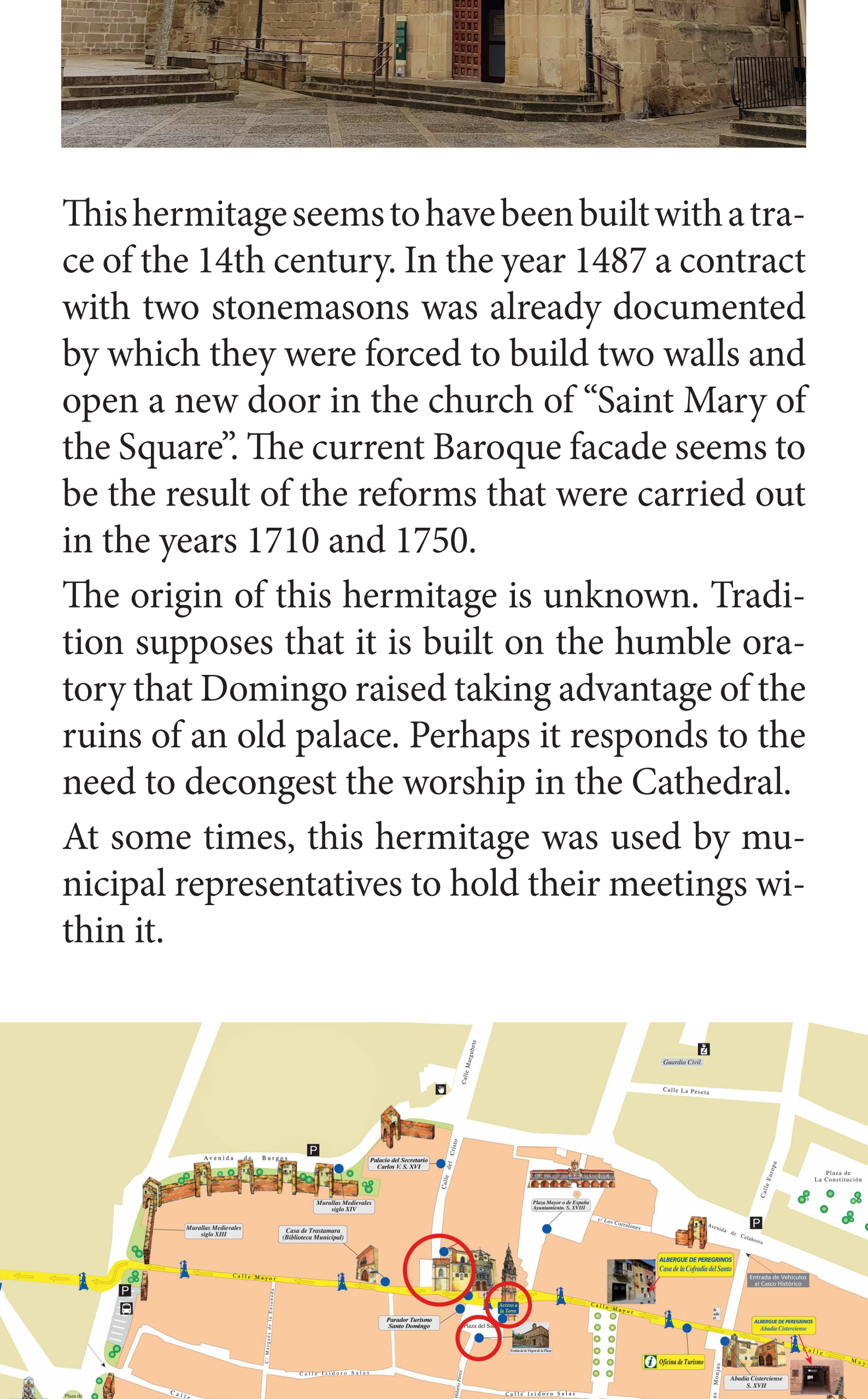


Virgin of the Square

2.- Altarpiece

The altarpiece that frames the carving of the Virgin of the Square is from the 20th century and in it we find two paintings: the first one with Santo Domingo de la Calzada and another with San Jerónimo Hermosilla, a saint born in this city and martyred in the 19th century in Vietnam. On the bench of the altarpiece, from left to right: Santo Domingo de Silos, contemporary of Santo Domingo de la Calzada, the Immaculate Virgin, united to the devotion of the Saint, the door of the tabernacle; the Virgin of Valvanera and San Millán de la Cogolla, both monasteries visited in his youth by Santo Domingo de la Calzada.

Altarpiece of the Hermitage



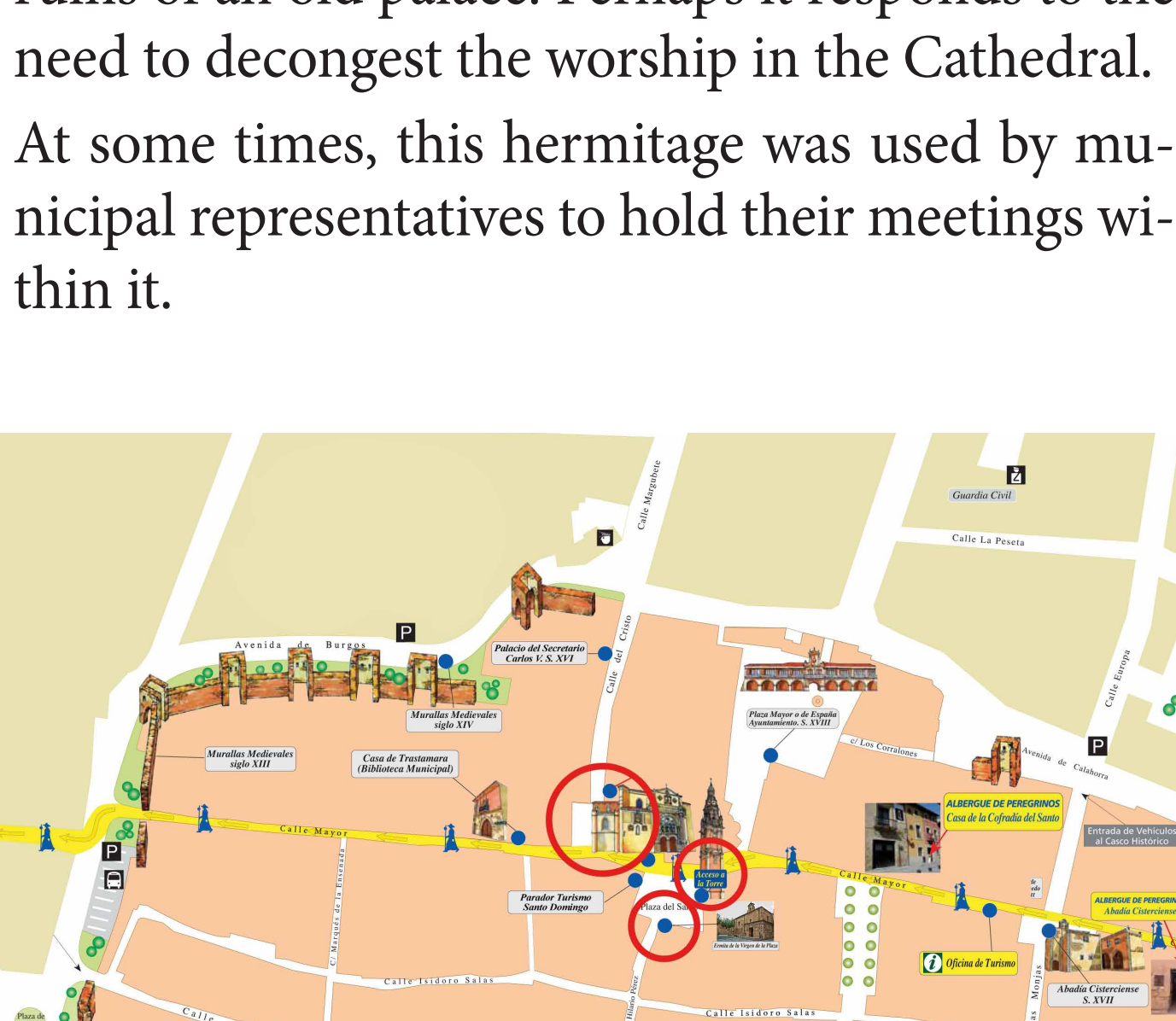
3.- Chorus

The choir is located at the foot and, the small sacristy, at the head, behind an altarpiece of modern construction.



Chorus of the Hermitage

THE ORIGIN



This hermitage seems to have been built with a trace of the 14th century. In the year 1487 a contract with two stonemasons was already documented by which they were forced to build two walls and open a new door in the church of "Saint Mary of the Square". The current Baroque facade seems to be the result of the reforms that were carried out in the years 1710 and 1750.

The origin of this hermitage is unknown. Tradition supposes that it is built on the humble oratory that Domingo raised taking advantage of the ruins of an old palace. Perhaps it responds to the need to decongest the worship in the Cathedral.

At some times, this hermitage was used by municipal representatives to hold their meetings within it.

